FOR OFFICIAL USE

National Qualifications 2026

Mark

X827/76/01

ESOL Listening

WEDNESDAY, 13 MAY

1:00 PM – 1:45 PM (approx)

X8277601

Fill in these boxes and read what is printed below.

Full name of centre

Town

Forename(s)

Surname

Number of seat

Date of birth

Day Month Year

Scottish candidate number

Total marks — 25

Attempt ALL questions.

You will hear three different recordings. **Before you hear each recording, you will have one minute to read the questions.** You will hear each recording twice, with an interval of ten seconds between playings. After you hear the second playing of each recording you will have one minute to finish answering the questions.

You must NOT use a dictionary.

Write your answers clearly in the spaces provided in this booklet. Additional space for answers is provided at the end of this booklet. If you use this space you must clearly identify the question number you are attempting.

Use **blue** or **black** ink.

You are not allowed to leave the examination room until the end of the test.

Do not remove any exam materials. You must leave this booklet on your desk; if you do not, you could lose all the marks for this paper.

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Total marks — 25

Attempt ALL questions

Recording 1

Listen to the recording and attempt the questions which follow. You will hear the recording twice. You now have one minute to read the questions in Recording 1 before the recording begins.

Questions 1–5: Complete the sentences below with **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS.**

1. According to Sarah, digital trails make it more difficult for crimes to be committed _____ of the authorities. **1**

2. Sarah notes that it is becoming increasingly difficult _____ _____ biometric security. **1**

3. Mike is concerned that _____ are becoming more regular. **1**

4. Mike's company suffers a lot because of the high _____ _____ involved. **1**

5. Sarah dismisses Mike's argument by saying that the world will keep _____. **1**

Recording 1 questions (continued)

Question 6: Choose the correct answer for the question below and tick (✓) **one** box.

6. The area where Mike lives: **1**

A has several local stores. ☐

B has poor mobile phone reception. ☐

C has many older residents. ☐

D has a large population. ☐

Question 7: Choose the correct answers for the question and tick (✓) **THREE** boxes.

7. Which **THREE** views does Sarah express about privacy? **3**

A People are accustomed to sharing their data online. ☐

B Social media should be used with caution. ☐

C Smartphone data needs to be analysed more. ☐

D The use of digital payments is a risk-free process. ☐

E Reluctance to share personal details is understandable. ☐

F More needs to be done to protect data from criminals. ☐

G Systems that share financial data can be beneficial. ☐

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Recording 2

Listen to the recording and attempt the questions which follow. You will hear the recording twice. You now have one minute to read the questions in Recording 2 before the recording begins.

Questions 8–10: Choose the correct answer for each question and tick (✓) **one** box.

8. What was the biggest challenge for Anna in relation to her work meeting? **1**

A Doing additional preparation. ☐

B Taking a very long flight. ☐

C Going to a different time zone. ☐

D Organising it around her child. ☐

9. What prevented Anna from leaving her baby in Australia? **1**

A She could not count on help from family. ☐

B She was not ready to stop breastfeeding him. ☐

C She did not want to be separated from him. ☐

D She was unsure when she would return home. ☐

10. What made Anna finally decide to take her son with her? **1**

A Her mother was supportive of the decision. ☐

B She got advice from a friend who had done it before. ☐

C She read information online which put her mind at ease. ☐

D Many airlines offered baby facilities onboard. ☐

Recording 2 questions (continued)

Questions 11–14: Complete the sentences below with **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS.**

11. During the flight, Anna was woken up by the _____ _____. **1**

12. Anna was worried about the venue's lack of a/an _____ _____. **1**

13. Anna's employer was unable to _____ a childcare provider. **1**

14. Despite the _____, Anna was initially anxious about leaving her son with the nanny. **1**

Question 15: Choose the correct answer for the question below and tick (✓) **one** box.

15. How did the people in the meeting feel about Anna's situation? **1**

A They found updates from Anna's childminder distracting. ☐

B They thought it was unprofessional to bring a baby with her. ☐

C They made allowances to accommodate her. ☐

D They were impressed with how she had managed things. ☐

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Recording 3

Listen to the recording and attempt the questions which follow. You will hear the recording twice. You now have one minute to read the questions in Recording 3 before the recording begins.

Questions 16–19: Complete the sentences below with **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS.**

16. For many students, the _____ will quickly disappear. **1**

17. You now need a degree to get into _____. **1**

18. Universities have started using _____

in the advertising of their courses. **1**

19. Teachers who worry too much about exam marks end up _____

_____ to their pupils. **1**

Questions 20–23: Choose the correct answer for each question and tick (✓) **one** box.

20. What does Sabine say about alternatives to end-of-year exams? **1**

A Each of the other available options has a downside. ☐

B A system with more coursework would be a fairer one. ☐

C Students should do some assessments at home. ☐

D Continuous assessment means less pressure overall. ☐

Recording 3 questions (continued)

21. What disappointed Sabine when she marked papers with a co-worker? **1**

A The candidates' lack of ability with punctuation. ☐

B The co-worker's attitude to the marking instructions. ☐

C The general ability shown by candidates. ☐

D The inflexible exam criteria in the marking instructions. ☐

22. Sabine thinks we should make exams fairer by: **1**

A allowing students to re-sit where necessary. ☐

B ranking students more carefully. ☐

C making exams more competitive. ☐

D using exams to recognise basic competencies. ☐

23. What does Sabine think causes the main problem with exams? **1**

A Society. ☐

B Teachers. ☐

C Markers. ☐

D Universities. ☐

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